

AI-Powered Business Directory Platform

Product Requirements, Features, Modules, SEO & Monetization Specification

Version 1.0 | India-first | Chennai/Tamil Nadu launch strategy

Executive Summary

This document defines a business directory and local business discovery platform designed to help customers discover, compare, trust, contact and book businesses, while helping businesses create an online presence, generate leads and grow. The platform should go beyond a traditional directory by combining AI search, verified business data, SEO-friendly business pages, lead matching, comparison, business intelligence, mini-websites, reviews, offers and subscriptions.

1. Product Vision

The product should not simply answer 'Where is a business?'. It should answer: 'Which business is best for my requirement, why is it suitable, how trustworthy is it, and how can I contact it immediately?'

Customer journey: Discover → Compare → Trust → Contact → Book → Review

Business journey: Create → Get discovered → Receive leads → Convert → Build reputation → Grow

2. Market & Competitive Baseline

Major platforms such as Justdial, Sulekha, IndiaMART and TradeIndia already cover many conventional directory capabilities. Therefore, basic listings, maps, reviews, claim profiles, paid listings and SEO should be treated as baseline capabilities rather than the core differentiator.

- Justdial
- Sulekha
- IndiaMART
- TradeIndia
- Google Business Profile
- Industry-specific directories

3. Core Differentiation

1. AI natural-language business search
2. AI business recommendations with transparent reasons
3. Business comparison with AI decision support
4. Verified/transaction-based reviews
5. Business Trust Score and Business Health Score
6. Intelligent lead matching
7. Customer request marketplace
8. Competitor intelligence
9. Automatic business mini-website
10. Digital business card and QR system
11. Search analytics showing actual customer queries
12. AI-powered SEO recommendations
13. Duplicate business detection and data-quality scoring
14. Review intelligence and summaries

4. User Roles

Guest

Search, browse, view profiles, compare, view reviews/offers, call, WhatsApp and request information.

Customer

Save/follow businesses, review, upload media, request quotes, chat, book, manage enquiries and receive notifications.

Business Owner

Register/claim business, verify, manage profile/branches/services/products/offers, receive leads, chat, manage reviews, view analytics and subscribe.

Admin

Manage users, businesses, categories, locations, reviews, verification, subscriptions, ads, payments, SEO, CMS, reports and platform settings.

Moderator

Approve/reject listings, moderate reviews, verify documents, handle reports, duplicates and suspicious activity.

5. Main Functional Modules

Authentication

- Email/mobile registration
- OTP login
- Google/Apple login
- Password recovery
- RBAC
- Session/device management
- Login history

Business Listing

- Business/legal/display name
- Logo and cover
- Description
- Category/subcategory
- Services/products
- Phone/WhatsApp/email/website
- Social links
- Address, coordinates and PIN
- Hours and holiday hours
- Price range
- Payment methods
- Languages and accessibility

Dynamic Category Fields

- Category-specific fields for restaurants, hospitals, gyms, IT companies and other verticals
- Admin-configurable custom fields

Business Profile

- SEO-friendly mini-site
- About, services, products, pricing, photos, videos, reviews, offers, FAQ, location, hours, branches and contact

Claim & Verification

- Claim existing listing
- OTP verification
- Business/location/website verification
- Verification levels and badges

Search & Discovery

- Keyword search
- Category/service search

- Location search
- Distance/radius
- Rating, price, open-now, verified, offer and availability filters

Maps

- Map/list view
- Map clustering
- Directions
- Nearby businesses
- Distance calculation
- Map/list synchronization

Reviews

- 1–5 stars
- Written/photo/video reviews
- Service-specific reviews
- Helpful votes
- Reports
- Owner replies
- Moderation
- Verified reviews

Leads

- Get Quote
- Requirement form
- Lead routing
- Lead status
- Lead assignment
- Qualified lead tracking
- Conversion analytics

Chat

- Customer-business chat
- Text/images/documents
- Quotes
- Automated replies
- Read status

Bookings

- Calendar
- Slots
- Booking
- Cancellation
- Rescheduling
- Reminders

Offers

- Discounts
- Coupons
- Expiry
- Limited quantity
- Festival/new-customer offers

Business Dashboard

- Views
- Calls
- WhatsApp clicks
- Website clicks
- Directions
- Enquiries
- Bookings
- Reviews
- Followers
- Search impressions
- Profile score

Admin

- Businesses
- Users
- Categories
- Locations
- Reviews
- Leads
- Payments
- Subscriptions
- Ads
- Reports
- Fraud alerts

6. SEO-Friendly Business Page

Recommended URL:

<https://domain.com/chennai/software-development/acme-technologies>

- Unique SEO title and meta description
- Canonical URL
- BreadcrumbList structured data
- LocalBusiness/Organization structured data where applicable
- AggregateRating/Review structured data where eligible

- FAQ structured data where appropriate
- Open Graph and social metadata
- Fast server-rendered page
- Image alt text
- Stable URLs and 301 redirects
- Internal links to category, location, service and guide pages

7. Programmatic SEO Architecture

- /chennai/restaurants
- /chennai/restaurants/velachery
- /chennai/salons
- /coimbatore/software-companies
- /tamil-nadu/dentists
- /chennai/ac-repair/abc-air-solutions
- /guides/best-restaurants-in-chennai

Only create indexable pages where there is sufficient useful content and business inventory. Avoid thin, duplicate or low-value programmatic pages.

8. Business Data Quality & Trust

- Business Profile Strength score
- Business Trust Score
- Verification badges with explicit verification scope
- Duplicate detection using name, phone, email, website, address, coordinates and other available business identifiers
- NAP consistency monitoring
- Review authenticity and fraud detection
- Complaint/report history

9. AI Features

Natural Language Search

Understand queries such as 'cheap dentist near Velachery open today' and extract category, location, price and availability.

AI Recommendation

Rank suitable businesses using relevance, rating, reviews, distance, price, verification, availability and response rate, then explain why.

AI Comparison

Compare selected businesses and recommend the best option based on user requirements.

Review Intelligence

Summarize positive themes, common complaints and trends.

AI Profile Assistant

Generate draft business descriptions, service descriptions, FAQs, SEO titles and meta descriptions for owner approval.

AI SEO Assistant

Identify missing content, metadata, FAQ, services, images and other SEO opportunities.

AI Business Knowledge Layer

Connect businesses with categories, services, products, locations, reviews, offers, events and related businesses.

10. Business Website & Digital Identity

- Automatic mini-website for each business
- Business subdomain or profile URL
- Home/About/Services/Products/Gallery/Reviews/Contact/FAQ pages
- Digital business card
- QR code for profile, WhatsApp, review, offer, menu and appointment
- QR scan analytics

11. Lead Marketplace

Customers can publish a requirement such as 'Need a wedding photographer in Chennai, budget ₹1 lakh, date in December'. The platform matches the request with suitable businesses using category, location, budget, availability, service fit, business quality and response rate.

Lead statuses: New → Contacted → Interested → Quote Sent → Negotiation → Won/Lost

12. Business Ranking

Suggested ranking model:

- Relevance 25%
- Distance 15%
- Rating 15%
- Review quality 10%
- Verification 10%
- Profile completeness 10%
- Response rate 5%
- Freshness 5%

- Customer engagement 5%

Paid placement should never silently override relevance. Sponsored results must be clearly labelled.

13. Monetization

Free

Basic listing, profile, contact information, reviews, photos and basic analytics.

Business

Enhanced profile, more media, services, offers, analytics, lead management and review responses.

Premium

Featured placement, lead generation, advanced analytics, competitor intelligence, AI SEO and priority support.

Lead Fees

Charge for qualified leads in selected high-value categories.

Advertising

Homepage, category, location, sponsored business, sponsored content and newsletter placements.

14. Recommended Initial Pricing

- Free: ₹0
- Business: ₹499–₹999/month
- Premium: ₹1,999–₹4,999/month
- Lead pricing: category-dependent; approximately ₹50–₹1,000+ per qualified lead depending on value

These are starting hypotheses and should be validated with actual conversion and lead economics.

15. Local Guides & Content

- Best restaurants in Chennai
- Top gyms in Velachery
- Best wedding photographers in Coimbatore
- Top IT companies in OMR
- Best AC repair services in Chennai

Guide pages should link to relevant category, location and business pages to create a strong internal-linking network.

16. Business Intelligence

- Customer search-query analytics
- Competitor comparison
- Category rank
- Profile health score
- Review trends
- Lead conversion
- Response rate
- Improvement recommendations

17. Security & Anti-Fraud

- JWT/OAuth and secure refresh tokens
- RBAC
- Rate limiting and API throttling
- CAPTCHA where appropriate
- Input validation
- XSS/SQL injection protections
- File/image validation and scanning
- Audit logs
- Encryption
- Admin MFA
- Fake business/review detection
- Spam and duplicate detection

18. Recommended Technical Architecture

Frontend: Next.js + React + TypeScript + Tailwind CSS

Backend: Node.js/NestJS or Express + TypeScript; FastAPI/Python can be used for AI/data services

Database: PostgreSQL

Search: OpenSearch/Elasticsearch/Meilisearch depending on scale and requirements

Cache: Redis

Storage: AWS S3

CDN: AWS CloudFront

Maps: Google Maps or Mapbox

Payments: Razorpay initially; Stripe for international expansion

AI: LLM API + embeddings/vector search

Deployment: AWS with CI/CD

19. Core Database Entities

- User
- Business
- BusinessBranch
- BusinessOwner
- BusinessVerification
- Category
- CategoryField
- Location
- Service
- Product
- BusinessService
- BusinessProduct
- BusinessHours
- BusinessPhoto
- BusinessVideo
- Review
- ReviewMedia
- ReviewResponse
- Lead
- LeadAssignment
- LeadStatus
- Conversation
- Message
- Booking
- Offer
- Coupon
- Subscription
- Payment
- Advertisement
- BusinessAnalytics
- SearchAnalytics
- SavedBusiness
- Follow
- Report
- Notification

- FAQ
- Article
- Event
- SEOPage
- AuditLog

20. API Structure

- /api/v1/auth
- /api/v1/users
- /api/v1/businesses
- /api/v1/categories
- /api/v1/locations
- /api/v1/services
- /api/v1/products
- /api/v1/reviews
- /api/v1/leads
- /api/v1/bookings
- /api/v1/offers
- /api/v1/search
- /api/v1/analytics
- /api/v1/payments

21. MVP Scope

- Authentication
- Business registration and claim
- Business verification
- Categories and locations
- Search and filters
- Map
- SEO-friendly business pages
- Reviews
- Lead/enquiry system
- Business dashboard
- Admin dashboard
- Basic analytics
- Sitemap/schema/canonical SEO infrastructure
- Free and premium subscription foundation

22. Phase 2

- AI search

- AI recommendations
- Business comparison
- Offers
- Chat
- Booking
- Business website
- QR/digital card
- Advanced analytics
- Competitor intelligence

23. Phase 3

- Lead marketplace
- AI business intelligence
- Mobile apps
- B2B discovery
- Multi-language support
- International expansion

24. Launch Strategy

Do not launch all of India initially. Start with Chennai, then expand across Tamil Nadu and South India.

15. Restaurants
16. Salons
17. Gyms
18. Hospitals/clinics
19. Home services
20. Education/coaching
21. Wedding services
22. Automotive
23. IT/software companies
24. Real estate

Initial target: 1,000 quality businesses → 10,000 businesses → city-by-city expansion.

25. Suggested Domain Names

These are brand-name ideas, not availability confirmations. Check domain availability, trademarks, app-store names and social handles before registration.

- Bizora
- BizRadar

- BizScout
- LocalScout
- BizAtlas
- BizNest
- Localora
- BizGuide
- BizNear
- BizMap
- IndiaBizHub
- BizIndiaHub
- LocalBizIndia
- BharatBiz
- BharatLocal
- Bizly
- Localio
- Findora
- Findlio
- Nearora
- Locora

Top shortlist: Bizora, BizRadar, BizScout, LocalScout, BizAtlas, BizNest, Localora, BizGuide, BizNear, BizMap.

26. Recommended URL Architecture

- domain.com
- domain.com/chennai
- domain.com/chennai/restaurants
- domain.com/chennai/restaurants/velachery
- domain.com/chennai/restaurants/abc-restaurant
- domain.com/services/chennai/web-development
- domain.com/guides/best-restaurants-in-chennai
- app.domain.com
- api.domain.com

27. Product Positioning

Recommended positioning: “AI-powered local business discovery and growth platform.”

Customer promise: “Find the right business faster.”

Business promise: “Get discovered, generate leads and grow your online presence.”

28. Final Product Principle

The strongest strategy is not to compete with established directories simply by having more listings. Compete through better data, better search, stronger trust, better recommendations, qualified leads and better business tools. Traditional directories primarily help customers find businesses; this platform should help customers discover, compare, trust, contact, book and review, while helping businesses create, get discovered, receive leads, convert, build reputation and grow.

Appendix A — Feature Priority

- P0: Business listing, claim, verification, category/location, search, SEO business page, reviews, leads, business/admin dashboards
- P1: Map, subscriptions, analytics, offers, AI search, AI recommendation, comparison
- P2: Chat, booking, business mini-site, QR/digital card, competitor intelligence
- P3: Lead marketplace, B2B discovery, mobile apps, advanced business intelligence, internationalization